vSFG-7

VIRTUAL STRIKE FIGHTER GROUP SEVEN



AI ATC PHRASEOLOGY REFERENCE

SkyEye on SRS · every theatre

VMFA-225 Vikings · 421st FS Black Widows

F/A-18C Hornet · F-16C Viper

v3.1 · 25 OCT 2026

Built from SkyeyeATC ee6b136. Frequencies are read from the start scripts; every call in the tables is tested against SkyEye.

1. Frequency Map

Where SkyEye listens, read from the start scripts. All AM, except Hitman (FM). Mission preset channels differ - check the frequency, not only the channel.

Persian Gulf

Channel	Freq (MHz)	Type	Notes
Al Ain Tower	250.700	Two-way	Callsign: Al Ain Tower
Al Dhafra Tower	251.100	Two-way	Callsign: Al Dhafra Tower
Al Minhad Tower	250.100	Two-way	Callsign: Al Minhad Tower
Command	282.000	Two-way	Callsign: vSFG-7-Command
Deckboss - Carrier	128.600	Two-way	CVN-72 launch ops
Marshal - Carrier	306.300	Two-way	Recovery stack
Paddles - LSO	128.300	Two-way	Groove calls, ball call, deck calls
Overlord - GCI	266.000	Two-way	Picture, threats, bogey dope
ATIS - Al Ain	248.850	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Al Dhafra	248.200	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Al Minhad	248.300	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Kish	248.500	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Liwa	248.550	Listen only	Updates with the weather

Black Sea (Caucasus)

Channel	Freq (MHz)	Type	Notes
Batumi Tower	260.000	Two-way	Callsign: Batumi Tower
Kobuleti Tower	262.000	Two-way	Callsign: Kobuleti Tower
Kutaisi Tower	263.000	Two-way	Callsign: Kutaisi Tower
Mozdok Tower	266.000	Two-way	Callsign: Mozdok Tower
Senaki Tower	261.000	Two-way	Callsign: Senaki Tower
Tbilisi Tower	267.000	Two-way	Callsign: Tbilisi Tower
Command	282.000	Two-way	Callsign: vSFG-7-Command
Hitman 1-1 - JTAC	61.000 FM	Two-way	9-line targets 1-3
Hitman 2-1 - JTAC	62.000 FM	Two-way	9-line targets 4-5
Deckboss - Carrier	128.600	Two-way	CVN-72 launch ops

Channel	Freq (MHz)	Type	Notes
Marshal - Carrier	306.300	Two-way	Recovery stack
Paddles - LSO	128.300	Two-way	Groove calls, ball call, deck calls
Texaco 1-1 - Tanker	252.100	Two-way	KC-130, TACAN 51Y, angels 13
Texaco 3-1 - Tanker	252.300	Two-way	KC-135 MPRS, TACAN 53Y, angels 24
Darkstar - GCI	264.000	Two-way	Picture, threats, bogey dope
ATIS - Batumi	230.000	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Kobuleti	232.000	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Kutaisi	233.000	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Mozdok	237.000	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Senaki	234.000	Listen only	Updates with the weather

Syria (Eastern Med)

Channel	Freq (MHz)	Type	Notes
Akrotiri Tower	252.000	Two-way	Callsign: Akrotiri Tower
Bassel Al-Assad Tower	250.600	Two-way	Callsign: Bassel Al-Assad Tower
Beirut Tower	250.650	Two-way	Callsign: Beirut Tower
Incirlik Tower	360.100	Two-way	Callsign: Incirlik Tower
Ramat David Tower	251.300	Two-way	Callsign: Ramat David Tower
Command	282.000	Two-way	Callsign: vSFG-7-Command
Deckboss - Carrier	128.600	Two-way	CVN-72 launch ops
Marshal - Carrier	306.300	Two-way	Recovery stack
Paddles - LSO	128.300	Two-way	Groove calls, ball call, deck calls
Overlord - GCI	266.000	Two-way	Picture, threats, bogey dope
ATIS - Akrotiri	249.500	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Bassel Al-Assad	249.600	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Beirut	249.700	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Incirlik	360.200	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Ramat David	256.150	Listen only	Updates with the weather

Cold War Germany

Channel	Freq (MHz)	Type	Notes
Cologne Tower	119.700	Two-way	Callsign: Cologne Tower
Dusseldorf Tower	118.300	Two-way	Callsign: Dusseldorf Tower
Frankfurt Tower	127.300	Two-way	Callsign: Frankfurt Tower
Hahn Tower	119.500	Two-way	Callsign: Hahn Tower
Hamburg Tower	126.850	Two-way	Callsign: Hamburg Tower
Hannover Tower	120.200	Two-way	Callsign: Hannover Tower
Ramstein Tower	133.200	Two-way	Callsign: Ramstein Tower
Spangdahlem Tower	122.200	Two-way	Callsign: Spangdahlem Tower
Command	282.000	Two-way	Callsign: vSFG-7-Command
ATIS - Cologne	248.650	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Dusseldorf	248.700	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Frankfurt	248.600	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Hahn	248.150	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Hamburg	248.800	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Hannover	248.850	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Ramstein	248.000	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Spangdahlem	248.050	Listen only	Updates with the weather

Iraq

Channel	Freq (MHz)	Type	Notes
Al Asad Tower	363.700	Two-way	Callsign: Al Asad Tower
Al Sahra Tower	250.150	Two-way	Callsign: Al Sahra Tower
Al Salam Tower	250.250	Two-way	Callsign: Al Salam Tower
Balad Tower	250.550	Two-way	Callsign: Balad Tower
Command	282.000	Two-way	Callsign: vSFG-7-Command
ATIS - Al Asad	230.100	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Al Sahra	230.200	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Al Salam	230.300	Listen only	Updates with the weather
ATIS - Balad	230.700	Listen only	Updates with the weather

Kola

Channel	Freq (MHz)	Type	Notes
Bodo Tower	251.150	Two-way	Callsign: Bodo Tower
Command	282.000	Two-way	Callsign: vSFG-7-Command
Deckboss - Carrier	128.600	Two-way	CVN-72 launch ops
Marshal - Carrier	306.300	Two-way	Recovery stack
Paddles - LSO	128.300	Two-way	Groove calls, ball call, deck calls
Darkstar - GCI	264.000	Two-way	Confirm on the Kola card
ATIS - Bodo	249.150	Listen only	Updates with the weather

Carrier presets

Marshal 306.300 is Hornet COMM 1 CH 3 "CVN-72 AI MARSHALL" - that is SkyEye. 306.200 "CVN-72 MARSHAL" is kept for a live human Marshal.
Deckboss 128.600 is shared with the DCS AI carrier controller - you may hear both.

2. Addressing the Tower

The tower only responds when addressed. Any of these forms work:

Format	Example
Field name + Tower	"Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1, ..."
Field name alone	"Batumi, Raider 1-1, ..."
Field name + Traffic (CTAF)	"Senaki Traffic, Raider 1-1, rolling runway 09"
Bare - Tower	"Tower, Raider 1-1, ..."

Whisper mishear auto-corrections
Field names: a letter or two off still counts - helmand, el minhad -> Minhad; ldaf, delta for -> Dhafra; alan, el ain -> Al Ain. Mafraq also answers to King Hussein.
Callsigns: Reader / Radar / Rater -> Raider · Vino / Venue / Demon -> Venom.

3. Tower - Request Phraseology

3.1 Ground & Departure

Intent	Say something like	Response
Comm / Radio check	"...radio check" "...comm check" "...how copy" "...green jet"	Loud and clear
Request startup	"...request startup"	Startup approved
Request taxi	"...request taxi" "...ready to taxi"	Taxi to RWY XX, hold short
Holding short	"...holding short" "...at the hold" "...holding"	Line up and wait, then cleared for takeoff
Takeoff	"...ready for takeoff" "...request takeoff"	Cleared for takeoff
Airborne	"...airborne" "...departing"	Climb angels N, expect handoff at 7 DME
Rolling (CTAF)	"...rolling runway NN"	Same as airborne
7 DME / handoff (optional)	"...seven DME" "...seven miles" "...request handoff"	Copy if already handed off, else contact Command
Pushing Command	"...pushing command"	Good day

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Pilot:      "Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1, request taxi."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1, Batumi Tower, taxi to runway one three, altimeter two niner niner two, hold short."
Pilot:      "Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1, holding short."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1, runway one three, line up and wait."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1, wind one two zero at eight, runway one three, cleared for takeoff."
Pilot:      "Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1, airborne."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1, Batumi Tower, proceed to angels four, expect handoff at seven DME."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1, Batumi Departure, seven miles, angels four, leaving my airspace. Contact command, two
            eight two point zero, channel one. Good day."
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If you are held

Traffic inside 20 nm, or less than 60 s since the last departure, holds you. Stay put - the tower clears you when it is clear; you do not need to call again.
"seven miles" on its own is the departure call. Inbound, always say "inbound" or "initial" with a distance.

The 7-mile handoff

At 7 miles the tower calls you from Tacview - "<field> Departure ... leaving my airspace, contact command". You do not need to call 7 DME; if you do, the tower answers "copy". Call before 7 miles and you get the handoff then.
After takeoff "clear the active" counts as your airborne call. Fields with an Australian controller sign off "g'day".

3.2 Arrival & Pattern

Intent	Say something like	Response
Inbound (initial call)	"...N mile initial" "...N miles inbound"	Runway, wind, altimeter, report initial
Overhead	"...3 mile initial" "...overhead"	Break approved, number N, report base
Break	"...break"	Report downwind
Downwind	"...downwind"	Number N, report base
Base	"...base, gear down"	Cleared to land / affirmative
On final	"...on final" "...5 mile final"	Cleared to land, RWY XX
Touch and go	"...on final, touch and go"	Cleared touch and go
Straight-in	"...request straight in" "...ILS approach"	Straight-in approved, report final
Going around	"...going around"	Climb runway heading, report downwind
Runway vacated	"...runway vacated" "...clear of the active"	Taxi to parking

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Pilot:      "Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1, 10 mile initial."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1, Batumi Tower, runway one three, wind one two zero at eight, report initial."
Pilot:      "Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1, 3 mile initial."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1, left break runway one three, number one, report base."
Pilot:      "Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1, base, gear down."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1, runway one three, cleared to land."
Pilot:      "Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1, clear of the active."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1, taxi to parking."
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Good to know

Past 15 nm you hear "continue inbound, report N miles".
Say "gear down" in your base or final call, or the tower adds "check wheels down".
IMC (ceiling under 1,500 ft or visibility under 3 nm): no overhead - straight in only.

3.3 Multi-Ship Flights

The lead talks for the flight. Say the size and name the wingmen on the first call; one takeoff clearance and one landing clearance cover every jet, and the tower answers "<lead> flight".

Intent	Say something like	Response
Flight holding short	"...flight of two, Raider 1-2, holding short" "...flight of three, 1-2 and 1-3, holding short"	Raider 1-1 flight, flight of two, line up and wait
Flight takeoff	"...flight of two, ready for takeoff" "...two-ship, ready for takeoff"	One takeoff clearance for the flight
Flight inbound	"...flight of two, N miles inbound full stop" "...two-ship, N mile initial"	Raider 1-1 flight, runway, wind, report initial
Flight full stop	"...flight of two, full stop"	Cleared to land - the whole flight
Flight vacated	"...flight of two, clear of the active"	A parking spot for every jet

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Pilot:      "Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1, flight of three, 1-2 and 1-3, holding short."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1 flight, Batumi Tower, flight of three, runway one three, line up and wait."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1 flight, Batumi Tower, wind one two zero at eight, runway one three, cleared for
            takeoff."
Pilot:      "Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1 flight, airborne."
Pilot:      "Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1, flight of two, Raider 1-2, 10 miles inbound full stop."
Tower:      "Raider 1-1 flight, Batumi Tower, flight of two, runway one three, wind one two zero at eight,
            report initial."
Pilot:      "Batumi Tower, Raider 1-1 flight, clear of the active."
Ground:     "Raider 1-1 flight, taxi to parking, Raider 1-1 spot 12, Raider 1-2 spot 13."
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Flights
Size: "flight of two", "two-ship" or "three FA-18s". Wingmen right after the lead: "1-2 and 1-3", "302 and 303" or "Raider 302, Raider 303".
A wingman may call too: named, or flying within 2 nm of the lead (Tacview), he is answered as the flight.
The next departure waits the usual 60 s plus 20 s for each extra jet. Every jet gets a parking spot; unnamed wingmen get "spots 12, 13 and 14".

3.4 Any Time

Intent	Say something like	Response
Say again	"...say again"	Repeats your last call (2 min)
Wind / altimeter	"...wind check" "...say altimeter"	Wind and altimeter
Radar check	"...radar check"	Angels, range, bearing
Hung ordnance	"...hung ordnance"	Straight in, dearm at the end
Emergency	"...mayday mayday mayday" "...pan pan" "...declaring emergency, request runway NN"	The runway is yours - the one you name, if you name one
Souls and fuel (after an emergency)	"...one soul on board, fuel state 1.5"	Copy, crash crew standing by, cleared to land

Emergencies
"Declaring emergency, request runway 09": you get the runway you name, even against the active, for the rest of your approach. No runway named: the active.
The tower asks for souls on board and fuel state. Answer "one soul on board, fuel state 1.5" (or "fuel state zero"): the tower copies it, crash crew standing by, cleared to land.

The tower calls you when	Call
Over 350 kt inside 10 nm	Speed check
Inside 5 nm while a jet is rolling	Go around
A wind shift changes the runway	Runway in use is now NN
You were held and the traffic has cleared	Cleared for takeoff

4. Command Channel - 282.000 MHz

The squadron net in every theatre. Lead with "Command" and your callsign.

Intent	Say something like	Example Response
Radio check	"...radio check" "...how copy"	Loud and clear
Check in	"...checking in"	Loud and clear, proceed mission

Intent	Say something like	Example Response
Fence in	"...fence in, state 6.2"	Copy fence in, cleared hot; Black Sea and Syria add where the GCI is
On station	"...on station"	Copy on station, good hunting
Off station	"...off station"	Proceed to assigned pattern
Fence out	"...fence out"	Copy fence out, safe passage
RTB	"...RTB" "...request recovery"	Expect handoff at 30 nm
State	"...state 5.2"	Copy state; under 2.0 bingo
Bullseye	"...say bullseye"	Bullseye NNN for NN
Tanker	"...request tanker"	Nearest tanker: bearing, range, angels; a Texaco adds contact on its frequency
Tasking	"...request tasking"	Black Sea: contact Hitman 1-1 (61.0) or 2-1 (62.0)
In hot (no JTAC)	"...in hot"	Cleared hot
Release	"...pickle" "...rifle"	Copy pickle / copy rifle
Shot / kill	"...Fox 3" "...splash one MiG-29"	Copy Fox three / copy splash, good kill
Moving	"...inbound artillery battery" "...proceeding to IP Granite"	Copy

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Pilot:      "Command, Raider 1-1, fence in, state 6.2."
Cmd:        "Raider 1-1, Command, copy fence in, you are cleared hot."
Pilot:      "Command, Raider 1-1, request tasking."
Cmd:        "Raider 1-1, Command, contact Hitman one one on six one point zero zero zero for tasking."
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The automatic handoff

Once you have talked to Command it watches you on Tacview. Inside 30 nm of your recovery - a field, or the carrier if you launched from it - it calls you once with the tower or Marshal frequency.
Bullseye and tanker need the radar picture; without it you hear "unable". Tasking is Black Sea training only.
No JTAC up? After fence in, Command copies your attack calls: "in hot" gets cleared hot, "pickle" / "rifle" / "Fox 3" / "splash" get a copy. Pilots often use the flight number alone ("302, Fox 3") - Command finds the full callsign on Tacview.

5. Range Areas and Overlord Actual - Command

Black Sea training. The lettered areas A - O on the kneeboard's TARGET RANGES card. Tell Command where you are going and it tells you what is there; ask, and Overlord Actual (a second voice on Command's frequency) clears you. The 9-line areas D, H and I go to Hitman.

Intent	Say something like	Response

Intent	Say something like	Response
Going to an area	"...proceeding to Alpha" "...pushing Alpha" "...inbound Alpha"	What is there, threat, bearing; report off target
Asking for an area	"...request Alpha" "...permission to proceed to Alpha" "...request to work Alpha"	Stand by for Overlord Actual
Off target	"...off target" "...off Alpha" "...off and egressing"	Copy off; say intentions
Out of weapons	"...Winchester, RTB"	Copy Winchester, RTB, handoff at 30 nm
Fuel to get home	"...Bingo, RTB"	Copy Bingo, RTB, nearest tanker
Fuel low, still working	"...Joker"	Copy Joker

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Pilot:    "Command, Raider 1-1, permission to proceed to Alpha."
Cmd:      "Raider 1-1, Command, stand by for Overlord Actual."
Ovrld:    "Raider 1-1, Overlord Actual, you are Irene for Alpha, report copy."
Pilot:    "Raider 1-1, copy Irene."
Cmd:      "Raider 1-1, Command, copy Irene. Alpha, Maykop airfield, SA-6 site and parked aircraft. Threat
          SA-6. Alpha bears three-four-zero for 85. Report off target."
Pilot:    "Command, Raider 1-1, off Alpha, Winchester, RTB."
Cmd:      "Raider 1-1, Command, copy off Alpha, Winchester, RTB. Good work. Expect recovery handoff at three
          zero miles."
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How the areas work

Overlord comes up about 10 s after Command's stand by. He says "you are Irene" or "you are cleared to engage" - both mean go. "Negative" means another flight is working it: ask for another area.

Command gives the threat from what is actually there: E is an SA-10 site, G an SA-2 site, M the cruiser Moskva's group, K the Kuznetsov with SA-15 corvettes. The kneeboard card under-reports E, G and M.

Another flight on the same area is called out ("be advised, Venom 2-1 working Alpha"). Call off target when done so the area frees up.

Bingo: Command adds the nearest tanker when the rig has Tacview. The bearing needs Tacview too.

6. Hitman 1-1 / 2-1 - 61.000 and 62.000 FM (JTAC)

Black Sea training 9-lines, 100-127 nm north of Senaki past the main ridge. Hitman 1-1 (61.0, Hornet COMM 2 CH 12, Viper COMM 2 CH 8) runs Kuban Valley, targets 1-3; Hitman 2-1 (62.0, dial it - no preset yet) runs Cherkessk, targets 4-5. Command sends you to whichever has a free target. Lead with "Hitman".

Intent	Say something like	Response
Check in	"...checking in" "...request tasking"	target N, <name>, IP <IP>, read back
Readback	"...target N, <IP>" "...copy"	Good readback, report IP inbound
IP inbound	"...IP inbound"	Continue (or where the IP is)
In	"...in from the south" "...in heading 330"	Cleared hot - or abort, abort, abort

Intent	Say something like	Response
Off	"...off" "...off safe"	Egress per line 9
BDA	"...request BDA"	Effects, then re-attack, correction or home
Abort	"...abort"	Copy abort, re-attack from the IP
Radio check	"...radio check"	Loud and clear

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Pilot:      "Hitman 1-1, Raider 1-1, checking in."
Hitman:     "Raider 1-1, Hitman one one, target 4, Fuel Depot, IP Indigo. Read back."
Pilot:      "Hitman, Raider 1-1, target 4, Indigo."
Hitman:     "Raider 1-1, Hitman one one, good readback. Report IP inbound."
Pilot:      "Hitman, Raider 1-1, IP inbound."
Hitman:     "Raider 1-1, Hitman one one, continue."
Pilot:      "Hitman, Raider 1-1, in from the east."
Hitman:     "Raider 1-1, Hitman one one, cleared hot."
Hitman:     "Raider 1-1, Hitman one one, BDA. Impact on the aim point. Partial effects. Large tanks, 2 of 4
            destroyed. 3 of 14 on target destroyed. Re-attack approved, report IP inbound from Indigo."
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What Hitman checks (Tacview, against your 9-line card)

IP inbound: within 20 nm of the IP, nose on the target. Off the run-in line you hear "continue, run in heading NNN".
In call: inside the card's final attack heading and 0.5 - 15 nm from the target - otherwise abort, abort, abort.
After cleared hot: a run that swings 10 deg outside the window before release is aborted.
BDA about 15 s after impact, one of four: good effects (go home or ask for more), partial effects (re-attack), no effects (a correction, e.g. "correct south 300", then re-attack), or unable to assess - the bridges - when Hitman asks "say your observed effects": answer "bridge dropped" or "no effects".
No radar picture of you: no checks, and you are still cleared hot. JTAC LIVE 60.000 is a human JTAC.

7. Deckboss - 128.600 MHz (Carrier Launch)

Manages cats 1-4 on CVN-72. If all cats are taken you join the conga line (six). Lead with "Deckboss"; the airborne call needs no address.

Intent	Say something like	What Happens
Check in for launch	"...request taxi" "...green jet"	Cleared to cat N, or the conga line
Ready on cat	"...ready cat N" "...shoot"	Under tension, spin it up
Airborne	"...airborne"	Push Marshal 306.3
BRC	"...say BRC"	Mother's BRC, magnetic
Pushing Marshal	"...pushing Marshal"	Short ack
Radio check	"...radio check"	Loud and clear

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Pilot:      "Deckboss, Raider 1-1, request taxi."
Deck:       "Raider 1-1, Deckboss, cleared to cat two."
Pilot:      "Deckboss, Raider 1-1, ready cat two."
Deck:       "Raider 1-1, Deckboss, under tension cat two, spin it up, shooter's discretion."
Pilot:      "Raider 1-1, airborne."
Deck:       "Raider 1-1, Deckboss, copy airborne, push Marshal, three zero six point three."
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8. Marshal - 306.300 MHz (Carrier Recovery)

Manages the recovery stack. Marshal ignores a call that does not start with "Marshal" or has no number in your callsign. The case (I, II or III) is set from time and weather.

Intent	Say something like	Response
Check in	"...checking in"	Range and bearing, say marking moms
Marking moms	"...marking moms, angels 12, state 6.5"	Weather, case, BRC, Marshal at angels N
BRC	"...say BRC"	Mother's BRC, magnetic
DME report	"...20 DME"	Radar contact, continue
Inbound 10 nm	"...see you at ten"	Visual at ten, say state
Fuel state	"...state 5.2"	Copy state; under 2.0 expedite
Established	"...established angels 2"	Signal Charlie, or hold
Commencing	"...commencing"	Check in three mile initial
Push time (Case III)	"...request push time"	Expected approach time MM (a new one if yours has passed)
Platform (Case III)	"...platform"	Final bearing NNN; at three miles Marshal hands you to Paddles
Needles (Case III)	"...needles up and left" "...negative needles"	Roger needles / roger negative needles, fly bullseye
Coupled (Case III)	"...coupled" "...command control"	Roger coupled / roger command control
Initial	"...initial"	Contact paddles, good luck
Clear (departure)	"...clear seven miles"	Push Command 282.0
Radar check	"...radar check"	Angels, range, bearing from mother
Radio check	"...radio check"	Loud and clear

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Pilot:      "Marshal, Raider 1-1, marking moms 340 for 30, angels 12, state 6.5."
Marshal:    "Raider 1-1, Union Marshal, radar contact, angels 12, range 30 miles, bearing three four zero from
            mother, expect Case One recovery, BRC 275, altimeter two niner niner two, Marshal at angels two,
            report see me at ten."
Pilot:      "Marshal, Raider 1-1, established angels two."
Marshal:    "Raider 1-1, Union Marshal, signal Charlie."
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Case III (night, or ceiling under 1,500 ft / visibility under 3 nm)
Marking moms gets a holding fix and a push time: marshal on the NNN, DD DME, angels N, expected approach time is MM. The stack starts at angels 6; the DME is angels + 15 (angels 6 at 21 DME).
Commencing: descend to platform 5,000, final bearing NNN. Call "platform" passing 5,000 ft. At three miles Marshal says "contact paddles, call the ball": switch and make the ball call at three-quarters.
Needles, coupled and command control reports get a "roger"; negative needles gets "fly bullseye". Calls after commencing may start with your modex alone.
Marshal radial = final bearing + 180. Final bearing = BRC - 9. All magnetic.

9. Paddles - 128.300 MHz (LSO)

SkyEye's LSO on CVN-72 Abe (Black Sea Day / Night and Foothold Syria). Hornet COMM 2 CH 4. Marshal sends you here at the initial, or in Case III at three miles ("contact paddles"). Paddles talks you down the glideslope from Tacview: you fly, he calls. Give your modex or full callsign; the examples use Raider 302.

Intent	Say something like	Response
Radio check	"...radio check"	Loud and clear
In the break	"...in the break"	Roger, call abeam
Case III check-in	"...three-mile initial"	Paddles contact, call the ball at three-quarters of a mile
Abeam (the 180)	"...abeam"	Paddles contact, Hornet in the groove, at three-quarters of a mile call the ball
Ball call	"...Hornet ball, 5.5" "...three-quarter mile, 5.4"	Roger ball
No ball in sight	"...Clara, 5.0"	Paddles contact, keep it coming
After the trap	"...red deck"	No reply - the deck is foul, the next jet is waved off at 1/4 nm
Clear of the landing area	"...green deck"	Roger green deck, contact Deckboss 128.6

```
Pilot:      "Paddles, Raider 302, abeam."
Paddles:    "Paddles contact, Raider 302, Hornet in the groove, at three-quarters of a mile call the ball."
Pilot:      "302, Hornet ball, 5.5."
Paddles:    "Roger ball."
Paddles:    "You're high, bring it down."
Pilot:      "302, red deck."
Pilot:      "302, green deck."
Paddles:    "302, Paddles, roger green deck, contact Deckboss, one two eight point six."
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In the groove (no readback)
Calls start about 0.8 nm (1.3 nm after your ball call): a little high, you're high, you're low - power, POWER, right for lineup, come left, you're fast / slow (Hornet AoA). After your ball call, a call every second while you are off.
No ball call by about 0.6 nm: "call the ball". Wave off, wave off, wave off: mandatory - power, climb straight ahead.
Foul deck at 1/4 nm (no green deck from the jet ahead, or Tacview shows the landing area foul): "302, foul deck, wave off, wave off, proceed to bolter pattern". A red deck lapses after 3 minutes.

10. Texaco - 252.100 / 252.300 MHz (Tankers)

Black Sea Day / Night. Texaco 1-1: KC-130, 252.100 AM (Hornet COMM 2 CH 8), TACAN 51Y, angels 13, about 260 KIAS. Texaco 3-1: KC-135 MPRS, 252.300 AM (COMM 2 CH 10), TACAN 53Y, angels 24, about 265 KIAS. Two baskets each; the same calls work on both ("Texaco 1" or "Texaco 3"). The calls follow the vSFG-7 AAQ Aerial Refueling Procedure: observation is always port, reform always starboard.

Step	Say something like	Texaco
Radio check	"...comm check" "...radio check"	Loud and clear
Initial	"...15 mile initial for port observation, intent to refuel"	Cleared port observation, angels, velocity. How much do you request?
Give	"...request 5.0" "...request full"	You are cleared for five thousand pounds / full give
1 mile trail	"...1 mile trail for port observation"	Continue port observation
Observation	"...established port observation" "...establish portside"	Copy. Port and starboard baskets open
Basket	"...moving to port basket"	Cleared port basket (or standby, basket occupied)
At the basket	"...established port basket"	Copy, call ready pre-contact
Ready	"...ready pre-contact"	Cleared contact, port basket
Reform	"...satisfied, moving to starboard reform"	Cleared starboard reform
In reform	"...established starboard reform" "...establish starboard side"	Copy
Check out	"...checking out, pushing 282" "...moving on to mission"	Cleared to depart - Fortuna super te, Viking / Stay classy, Raider / Fara í víking

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Pilot:      "Command, Raider 1-1, request tanker."
Cmd:        "Raider 1-1, Command, Texaco 1-1 bears zero four five for 32, angels 13. Contact Texaco one one on
            two five two point one."
Pilot:      "Texaco 1-1, Raider 1-1, 15 mile initial for port observation, intent to refuel."
Texaco:     "Raider 11, Texaco one one, cleared port observation, one three thousand, velocity two six zero.
            How much do you request?"
Pilot:      "Texaco 1-1, Raider 1-1, request 5.0."
Texaco:     "Raider 11, Texaco, you are cleared for five thousand pounds."
Pilot:      "Texaco 1-1, Raider 1-1, moving on to mission."
Texaco:     "Raider 11, Texaco, cleared to depart. Stay classy, Raider."
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Tanker rules

Lead makes the initial, trail, observation and check-out calls; each jet its own basket and reform calls. Give your amount in the initial ("... intent to refuel, request 6.0") and Texaco copies it instead of asking.

One jet per basket: a held basket gets "standby, basket occupied" - it frees when that jet calls reform, or after 10 minutes. A bare "ready pre-contact" counts when you are the only jet on the tanker.

Altitude and velocity come live from Tacview. SkyEye is radio only: DCS still needs the AI comms menu Ready pre-contact before fuel flows.

11. GCI - Darkstar 264.000 / Overlord 266.000 MHz

SkyEye's GCI (AWACS) controller in our voice, a British woman. Blue coalition. Black Sea Day / Night: Darkstar on 264.000 AM (Hornet COMM 1 CH 5). Syria (Foothold): Overlord on 266.000 AM - dial it, the Foothold cards number channels per airframe. Lead with "Darkstar" (or "Overlord", or "Anyface"), then your callsign, then the request. Your fence check goes here and the picture follows. Command still copies fence in and adds "Darkstar is up on two six four point zero for picture" (Syria: Overlord, two six six).

Intent	Say something like	Response
Radio check	"...radio check" "...comm check"	Good copy / 5 by 5 - off scope adds "but I don't see you on scope"
Check in	"...checking in"	Radar contact
Fence in	"...fence in"	Copy fence in, picture follows - the picture a few seconds later
Alpha check	"...alpha check"	Contact, alpha check bullseye 010/48
Picture	"...picture" "...request picture"	Up to 3 groups: bullseye, altitude, track, ID, contacts, type
Bogey dope (nearest)	"...bogey dope"	Group BRAA 045/32, 25000, hot, hostile, Flanker
Jets only	"...any fast movers" "...bogey dope airplanes"	Nearest fixed-wing group, as bogey dope
Helicopters only	"...any slow movers" "...bogey dope helicopters"	Nearest helicopter group, as bogey dope
Declare (bullseye)	"...declare bullseye 010 for 48 at 25000"	Hostile, friendly, furball or clean
Snaplock (BRAA)	"...snaplock 125 for 10 at 8000"	Threat BRAA 125/10, 8000, hot, hostile, Flanker

Intent	Say something like	Response
Spiked / strobe	"...spiked 080" "...strobe 080"	Spike range 35, 16000, flank northeast, hostile - or clean 080
Vector	"...vector to tanker"	Bearing and range to the nearest tanker
Splash	"...splash one" "...splash"	Copy splash one / copy splash
Fence out	"...fence out"	Copy fence out
Check out	"...checking out"	Copy, good day

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Pilot:    "Darkstar, Raider 302, checking in."
GCI:      "Raider 3 0 2, Darkstar, radar contact."
Pilot:    "Darkstar, Raider 302, fence in."
GCI:      "Raider 3 0 2, Darkstar, copy fence in, picture follows."
GCI:      "Darkstar, 2 groups. Group bullseye zero one zero, 48, 25000, track southwest, hostile, 2 contacts,
           Flanker. ..."
Pilot:    "Darkstar, Raider 302, bogey dope."
GCI:      "Raider 3 0 2, group BRAA zero four five, 32, 25000, hot, hostile, Flanker."
Pilot:    "Darkstar, Raider 302, checking out."
GCI:      "Raider 3 0 2, Darkstar, copy, good day."
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Your name must carry your callsign

DCS name "Raider 302 | Name" or "Venom 212 | Name" - the GCI finds Raider / Venom and the number anywhere in it. Your SRS name must be the same as your DCS name, or threat and merged calls never reach you.
Bearings: say the three digits ("zero six five"); ranges and altitudes as normal numbers. No "niner" / "tree".

The GCI calls you, unasked (only if you are on its frequency)	Call
Every 5 minutes	Picture
A hostile inside 25 nm (repeats every 3 min)	Threat
Inside 3 nm of a hostile (fixed wing)	Merged
A hostile off scope for 30 s	Faded
The GCI comes online (mid-mission = it restarted)	Sunrise
No AWACS airborne / back up ("All players, Darkstar, off station / on station")	Off / on station

What the GCI can see

Only what the mission's own AWACS could: the E-3 out to about 217 nm, the E-2 about 200 nm, and nothing below its radar horizon - a bandit on the deck far out is invisible until it climbs or closes, and one that drops out of coverage is called faded. Friendlies are always seen.

Terrain hides you too (Black Sea, Syria, Kola): a jet low in a valley behind a ridge from every AWACS drops off the picture until it climbs or an AWACS gets an angle on it.

No AWACS airborne (not up yet, or shot down): off station. Picture, bogey dope and declare get "off station, no picture"; radio check, fence, splash and check in / out still work.

The flow

Flow: Command check-in -> Darkstar check-in, fence in -> fly (picture, bogey dope, declare) -> fence out, checking out -> Command RTB -> Marshal or tower. Overlord Actual on Command (section 5) is the range officer, not the GCI.

12. General Tips

- **Always say your callsign.** Address first, then your full callsign with its number. Raider and Venom are auto-corrected from common mishearings.
- **Keep transmissions under 20 seconds.** Long calls are cut off. Two short calls beat one long one.
- **Pause half a second after keying,** then speak; wait 2 - 3 seconds for the answer and do not re-key over it.
- **CTAF style works.** "[Field] traffic, [callsign], [intent]" is recognised like a direct tower call.
- **Emergencies bypass sequencing.** "mayday", "pan pan" or "declaring emergency" puts you at the top of the queue; name a runway and it is yours.
- **ATIS letters only advance on a weather change.** Information Alpha three broadcasts running is expected.
- **Position calls need Tacview.** Radar check, bullseye, Hitman's checks and the 30 nm handoff need the rig's Tacview feed.

If the ATC doesn't respond

1. Addressed the right controller - field name, Command, Hitman, Deckboss, Marshal, Paddles, Texaco or Darkstar?
2. Included your full callsign with its number?
3. Used a call from the tables in this reference?
4. Right frequency (section 1), AM - or FM for Hitman? Encryption off?
5. SRS volume and mic - an open mic blocks reception. Still nothing: post the exact words you said.